

# WALTER D. BINGER

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## HOSPITALITY OPERATIONS | OPENINGS, BEVERAGE & GUEST EXPERIENCE

Restaurant & Bar Operations · Openings / Relaunches · P&L & Cost Control · Spanish / French

Hospitality operator with 15+ years across cooking, serving, bartending, fine dining, openings, ownership, management, and international restaurant work. Built and ran concepts in New York and Buenos Aires, helped carry a Brooklyn restaurant from construction into service, and later consulted on a bar program and hospitality operations in Benin. Guest experience has always been the center of the work: educate without lecturing, notice what the guest may not know to ask for, and make the operating system disappear behind the service.

## SELECTED IMPACT

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- Built Empanadas Son! from concept through daily operation and multiple locations on the Lower East Side; featured in TimeOut New York.
- Joined Prospect before opening and worked across construction, kitchen, bar, floor, and management as it became a functioning restaurant; later listed in the Michelin Guide.
- Ran Circus RestoBar entirely in Spanish and later built a bar program while consulting in Benin - practical beverage and cross-cultural operating experience.

## CORE STRENGTHS

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Restaurant & bar operations · Openings & relaunches · Guest experience & recovery · P&L / cost control · Bar & beverage programs · Hiring & training · Menu / vendor management · POS workflows · Multilingual service

## EXPERIENCE

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### Empanadas Son!

Feb 2015 - Jul 2016

*Owner, Proprietor & General Manager | Lower East Side, New York*

Built a quick-service restaurant from concept through daily operation, working hands-on across buildout, menu, brand, vendors, hiring, payroll, production, inventory, POS, counter service, and guest experience.

- Operated multiple locations and built the underlying systems from scratch; the concept was featured in TimeOut New York.
- Managed the business as both owner and floor-level operator, moving between kitchen, service, staffing, purchasing, and customer recovery as demand required.

### Prospect Restaurant

May 2012 - Jul 2014

*Opening Consultant / Line Chef / Expediter / Manager / Maintenance | Brooklyn, New York*

Joined before opening and stayed through the transition from construction project to working restaurant, operating in whatever role the day required.

- Supported buildout, opening systems, line execution, floor service, brunch, bar support, expediting, maintenance, and management; the restaurant was later listed in the Michelin Guide.
- Learned the full opening arc firsthand: design the workflow, launch it, watch where service breaks it, then keep adapting until the operation can carry volume.

### Circus RestoBar

May 2009 - Feb 2012

*General Manager / Operator / Executive Chef / Bartender | San Telmo, Buenos Aires, Argentina*

Rebuilt and ran a Buenos Aires hotel restaurant-bar entirely in Spanish for a multilingual clientele.

- Owned the food-and-beverage operation across menu, bar, events, vendors, staffing, POS/service workflows, guest recovery, and profitability.
- Combined kitchen, bar, floor, and management responsibilities rather than treating front and back of house as separate systems.

## **Chez Guillaume & Bio-Benin**

Winter 2017

*Restaurant & Hospitality Consultant | Natitingou, Benin*

Spent roughly four months advising on restaurant and hospitality operations in Benin.

- Created a bar program, supported renovation planning, and improved workflow, service structure, and guest experience for a café/restaurant serving local and international guests.
- Adapted recommendations to local resources and norms rather than importing a U.S. operating model.

## **SELECTED HOSPITALITY & BEVERAGE EXPERIENCE**

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- The Musket Room, New York - bartender in a fine-dining environment; part of a broader service career spanning bartending, serving, cooking, management, and ownership.
- Bar Stuzzichini, New York - management experience; Chanterelle, New York - independent culinary externship at age 17.
- Additional restaurant and service work includes Barano, Aragosta, The Farmhouse Inn, Le Rencard in France, and The Coop in California.
- Practical wine and beverage knowledge developed through years behind the bar, restaurant ownership, collaboration with wine professionals, and vineyard exposure in France and California.
- Guest-service philosophy centers on education and discovery: make recommendations confidently, introduce people to something they may not have considered, and enhance the experience without making it feel like a lesson.

## **TRANSFERABLE MULTI-SITE LEADERSHIP**

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- Later led an eight-facility healthcare district with 100+ employees and a \$5M+ operating portfolio, reinforcing the same fundamentals at larger scale: staffing, cost control, service recovery, training, and client trust.
- Recovered roughly \$45K per month across an 11-facility region in under six weeks and sustained better than 90% deficiency-free outcomes across roughly 32 surveys over three years.
- Developed frontline leaders as deliberately as service systems: promoted five cooks to Food Service Director, trained four managers from outside healthcare to deficiency-free first-year surveys, and advanced one director to District Manager.

## **BUILDOUT, DESIGN & OPERATING RANGE**

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- Maxwell and Son Contracting - foreman / head-carpenter experience on restaurant buildouts from demolition through opening; cabinetmaking and project-supervision work added hands-on understanding of how a hospitality space actually gets built.
- Later healthcare leadership scaled the same service fundamentals to eight facilities, 100+ employees, and a \$5M+ operating portfolio while building managers, controlling costs, and recovering service under pressure.

## **EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & SYSTEMS**

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Pitzer College - BA, International Intercultural Studies & Studio Art. Certified Dietary Manager (CDM/CFPP); ServSafe Manager. Fluent Spanish; conversational French.

Hospitality systems: Toast, Micros, Aloha, Square, Breadcrumb, inventory / production workflows, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, and Canva.